

REDUCE IMMIGRATION!

Are you worried about increased immigration into Australia and our high population growth rate?
About 70% of Australians* share your concern.

Both major parties' commitment to high immigration flies in the face of our environmental sustainability, our social cohesion and our cultural integrity. Annual immigration numbers have more than doubled between 1999 and 2013.

Whichever way you choose to vote, you can also use your ballot papers to send a message about the direction in which immigration numbers should go.

Participate in the **REDUCE IMMIGRATION** write-on campaign when you cast your vote, and let your opinion be known!

* <http://www.theage.com.au/national/majority-oppose-population-growth-survey-20100413-s7n5.html>

Here's how easy it is to show your concern:

At any federal, state or local election, you will receive the relevant ballot papers. (The illustrations here relate to a federal poll.) With these papers in hand, walk into the privacy of a voting booth. Then:

1. Fill in the squares for your valid vote on each paper.
2. At the top of each ballot paper, write **REDUCE IMMIGRATION**. If you write in the clear blank space, you cannot invalidate your vote.
3. Fold each of the papers, walk out of voting booth, and drop them into the correct ballot boxes on your way out ... so easy!

Illustration of a Senate Ballot Paper. At the top, the words "REDUCE IMMIGRATION" are written in blue ink. Below this, the text "Senate Ballot Paper" and "State Division of 8 Senators" is visible. The ballot paper features a grid of boxes for voting, with columns labeled A, B, C, D, E, and Ungrouped. Each column contains multiple rows of boxes for different parties. The AEC logo is at the bottom left.

Illustration of a House of Representatives Ballot Paper. At the top, the words "REDUCE IMMIGRATION" are written in blue ink. Below this, the text "BALLOT PAPER HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES" and "STATE ELECTORAL DIVISION OF DIVISION NAME" is visible. The ballot paper features a list of boxes for voting, numbered 1 to 8. Each box contains the text "SURNAME, Given names" and "PARTY". The AEC logo is at the bottom left.

What is a write-on campaign?

In Australia we are allowed to write messages on blank parts of a ballot paper to convey our personal views. A write-on campaign encourages people to write the same message on their ballot papers so as to convey a consistent idea to scrutineers, staff of the Australian Electoral Commission (AEC), other observers and the media when votes are being counted.

Is there a precedent?

At the Tasmanian referendum on 12 December 1981, voters wrote 'No Dams' on 33% of the ballot papers. Subsequently the write-on campaign against damming the Franklin River was promoted at federal by-elections in 1982. The 'No Dams' campaign delivered a 12% write-on in the Lowe by-election on 13 March 1982 and 40% in the Flinders by-election on 4 December 1982. The AEC and scrutineers reported this extraordinary surge of public opinion.

As a result, the ALP took note and promised to stop the Gordon below Franklin Dam. Bob Hawke fulfilled that pledge when the ALP came to office on the 'No Dams' policy platform in March 1983. This precedent shows that 'write-on' campaigns can influence political decision-making.

Further reading: http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Franklin_Dam_controversy (see sub-section: The campaign broadens)

Don't extra markings on a ballot paper invalidate my vote?

No, your vote will still be valid. The AEC has confirmed that you can write extra words on a ballot paper so long as you don't obscure your numbered squares. Antony Green, the ABC's election commentator, has written: "Formality laws allow ballot papers to be counted even though they contain other markings, legible or otherwise. The only tests are that the markings do not obscure the formal marking of preferences..."

Further reading: <http://reduceimmigration.wordpress.com/2013/09/05/aec-removes-any-doubt-about-write-on-messages>
<http://blogs.abc.net.au/antonygreen/2011/11/strange-things-voters-do-to-ballot-papers.html>

What impact will this campaign have?

When votes are being counted, scrutineers and AEC officials will notice an effective write-on campaign. If sufficient voters share their concern about excessive immigration, the political parties and the media will definitely take notice.

Write REDUCE IMMIGRATION in the blank space at the top of your ballot papers, and help drive policy change for Australia!

Website: <http://reduceimmigration.wordpress.com> **Email:** reduceimmigration@hotmail.com

Feel free to share this leaflet around Australia, and to print it from the website!

If using this leaflet during an election campaign, be sure to include relevant authorisation and printing details, as required by the Electoral Commission.